

# POPCORN DOESN'T WANT TO GO TO SCHOOL

Popcorn doesn't want to go to school.

Each day, a new excuse.  
Each excuse, a little piece of fantasy.  
Each fantasy, a reflection of a real dilemma:  
the wish to grow... and the fear of letting go.

In this book, we follow Popcorn on his journey through contradictions  
and discoveries –  
between what he imagines and what he truly finds.

A gentle story about the pathways of childhood –  
where imagination protects, invents, and also helps us move forward.



Leonardo Araújo

Popcorn Doesn't Want to Go to School

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Illustrations created with the help of Sora and ChatGPT.

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To my daughter,  
who, behind every “I don’t want to go to school,”  
revealed a mind open to discovery  
and a heart pulled back by separation.



Refusing to go to school is, for many children, a natural step in their path toward growth. This refusal often comes in disguise – with traces of truth, seasoned by imagination. It's important to listen to what the child has to say and understand that, unable to fully express their feelings, they turn to the justifications that come first to mind.

In this book, we follow Popcorn on his journey of reluctance and discovery. Each day, his creative mind invents a new excuse to avoid going to school. And each day, reality shows that school can be fun and welcoming – and that while his excuses may seem true to him, they are often woven with fantasy.

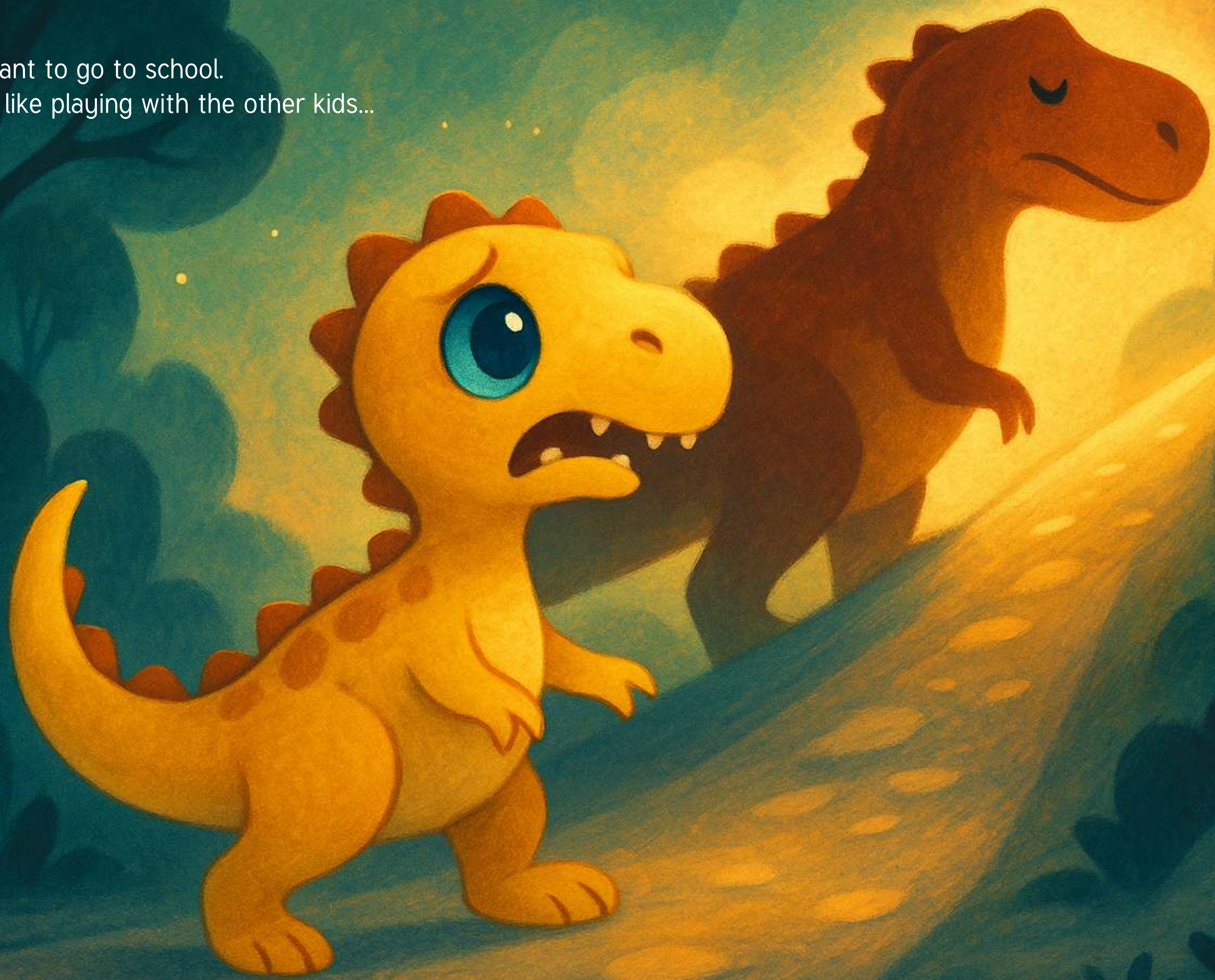
A child's imagination is powerful – and sometimes, it serves as a shield. With lightness and humor, this story invites adults and little ones to face this moment of transition with empathy, listening, and care.

Because, in the end, the hardest part isn't arriving at school... it's wanting to leave.





– I don't want to go to school.  
I don't like playing with the other kids...







Escola



– I don't want to go to school.  
I don't like the snacks there.









– I don't want to go to school.  
Music class is too noisy.











– I don't want to go to school.  
My leg hurts.







– I don't want to go to school.  
Literature class is boring.







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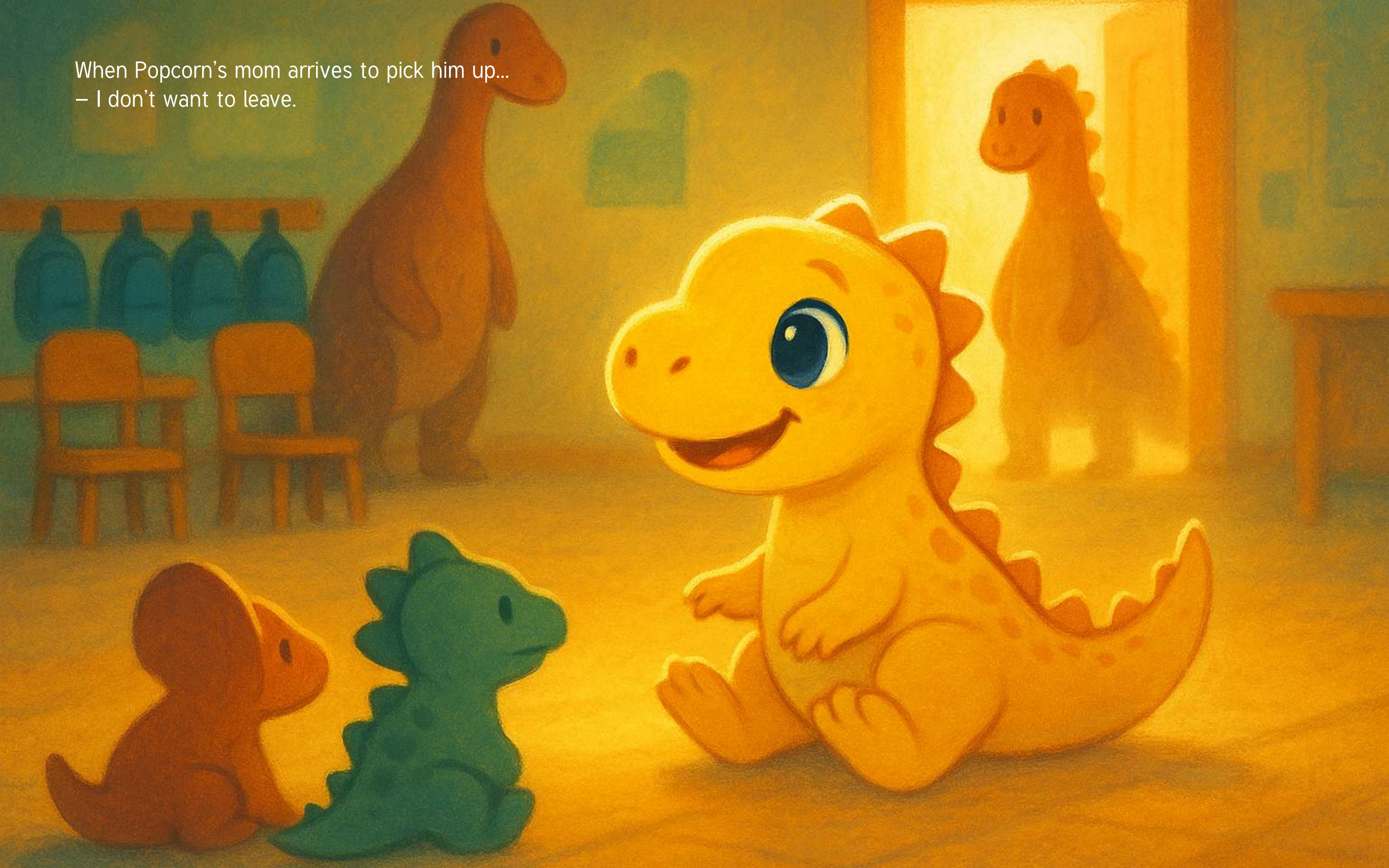


– I don't want to go to school.

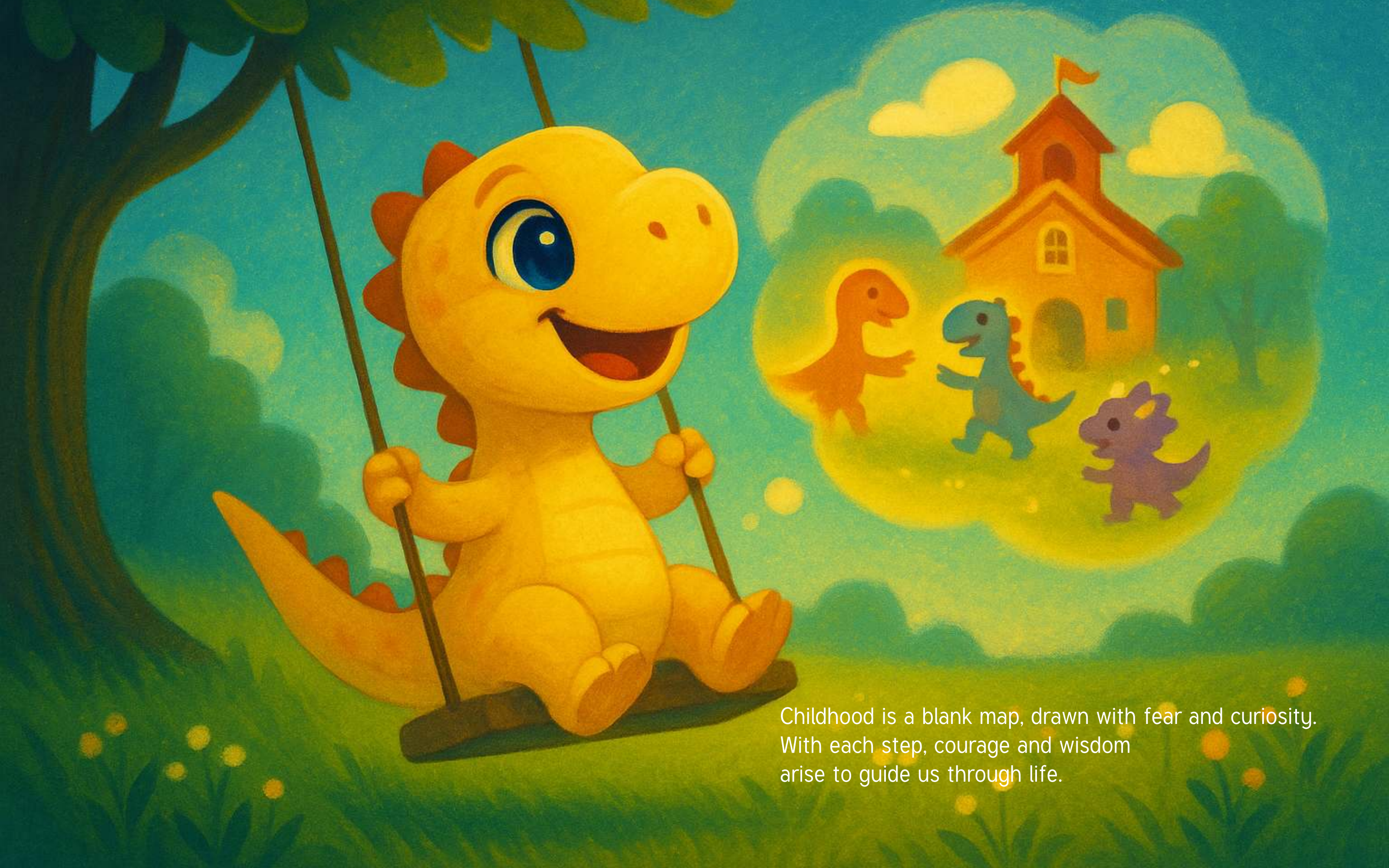




When Popcorn's mom arrives to pick him up...  
– I don't want to leave.







Childhood is a blank map, drawn with fear and curiosity.  
With each step, courage and wisdom  
arise to guide us through life.